

IN THE SENATE

SENATE CONCURRENT RESOLUTION NO. 119

BY RESOURCES AND ENVIRONMENT COMMITTEE

A CONCURRENT RESOLUTION

STATING FINDINGS OF THE LEGISLATURE REGARDING WATER DISTRICT 2 AND SUPPORT-
ING VARIOUS ASSOCIATED PROJECTS.

Be It Resolved by the Legislature of the State of Idaho:

WHEREAS, Water District 2 of the Idaho Water Resource Board (IWRB), encompassing the rapidly growing Southwest region including Ada, Adams, Boise, Canyon, Elmore, Gem, Owyhee, Payette, Valley, and Washington counties, represents the population and economic hub of the State of Idaho; and

WHEREAS, the reliable management of water resources in District 2 is essential for sustaining the agricultural heritage of the Treasure and Payette Valleys, supporting the rapid urbanization of the Boise metropolitan area, ensuring the operational viability of Mountain Home Air Force Base (MHAFB), and managing the delicate balance of the Treasure Valley Aquifer System; and

WHEREAS, IWRB has identified, funded, and overseen numerous projects critical to expanding storage capacity, stabilizing declining aquifers, and modernizing legacy infrastructure to meet future demands.

NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED by the members of the Second Regular Session of the Sixty-eighth Idaho Legislature, the Senate and the House of Representatives concurring therein, that the Legislature hereby formally recognizes the importance of and supports the continuation of existing and future projects within Water District 2.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the Legislature prioritizes the Anderson Ranch Dam Raise Project in the Boise River Basin as a critical investment in the region's future water security and acknowledges that the partnership with the Bureau of Reclamation to raise the dam by six feet will create approximately 29,000 acre-feet of new storage capacity, which is a vital step for capturing additional water supplies to mitigate drought, ensuring reliable supplies for the Boise River system's irrigators, and supporting the municipal needs of the Treasure Valley's rapidly expanding population.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the Legislature supports the ongoing Treasure Valley Managed Aquifer Recharge initiatives and recognizes that, as urbanization reduces natural incidental recharge from flood irrigation, it is necessary to develop infrastructure that actively recharges the Treasure Valley Aquifer, thereby preventing the resource depletion seen in other regions and ensuring a stable, long-term water supply for municipal and industrial users.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the Legislature commends the active construction of the water treatment plant by the Air Force at the MHAFB and the completion of the pipeline and pump station by IWRB, and declares that this project, which includes a conveyance system to deliver Snake River surface water to the base, is essential for national security and the Idaho economy, as it effectively secures the longevity of a military installation that con-

1 tributes over \$1 billion annually to the state economy while protecting lo-
2 cal groundwater resources for surrounding agricultural and community uses.

3 BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the Legislature acknowledges the vital im-
4 provements made through Aging Infrastructure Grants to the Last Chance Canal
5 Company in Gem and Payette Counties and recognizes that the rehabilitation
6 of this century-old infrastructure ensures the continued delivery of water
7 to the renowned agricultural lands of the Payette River basin, preventing
8 system failures that would devastate local crop production.

9 BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the Legislature acknowledges the recon-
10 struction of the headworks of the Ridenbaugh Canal, located on the Boise
11 River near Barber Park, as replacing this century-old infrastructure will
12 improve the reliability and predictability of water management on the Boise
13 River and ensure that local recreational activities, including boating and
14 fishing, can continue while also ensuring the continued delivery of water to
15 the neighborhoods and agricultural lands stretching from Boise to Caldwell.

16 BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the Legislature supports the modernization
17 efforts of the Boise City Canal Company and Water District 63 in Ada and
18 Canyon Counties, and affirms that, as the interface between urban develop-
19 ment and historic irrigation canals becomes more complex, these projects,
20 which range from piping open canals to automating headgates, are crucial
21 for public safety, water conservation, and the efficient delivery of water
22 rights amidst a densifying urban landscape.

23 BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the Legislature declares the projects
24 herein identified are independently and collectively vital to the strategic
25 interests of District 2 as they, among other benefits, secure municipi-
26 pal growth through new storage and recharge, strengthen national defense
27 through the MHAFFB resilience project, and modernize the agricultural roots
28 of the region through critical canal improvements.

29 BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the Legislature recognizes that the main-
30 tenance of water security requires a sustained commitment to future invest-
31 ment, particularly as District 2 faces the compounding pressures of rapid
32 population growth and aging infrastructure, and that proactive funding for
33 planning, modernization, and aquifer management is fiscally responsible
34 and essential to prevent the significantly higher costs associated with de-
35 ferred maintenance and emergency response.

36 BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the Legislature supports the continued ap-
37 propriation of funds to IWRB to ensure the completion and long-term viabil-
38 ity of these critical projects in Water District 2.